STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Resolution of OS Corruption using DISM and SFC

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1. Objective

To repair operating system files, resolve application hangs, patch random Blue Screen of Death (BSOD) errors, and restore core Windows stability.

2. Scope

Applicable to all Windows 10 and Windows 11 desktop environments showing signs of OS corruption or performance degradation.

3. Pre-requisites & Warnings

> - Requires an active internet connection so the DISM tool can fetch clean replacement files from Windows Update.
> - The scan process may take 15–30 minutes to complete.

4. Step-by-Step Procedure

4.1 Launch Elevated Command Prompt

- Search for **cmd** in the Windows start menu, right-click, and choose **Run as administrator**.

4.2 Scan and Repair the Windows Component Store Health

- Check the local image repository integrity:

```
DISM /Online /Cleanup-Image /ScanHealth
```

- If errors or component corruption are reported, execute the recovery command:

```
DISM /Online /Cleanup-Image /RestoreHealth
```

4.3 Execute System File Checker (SFC) Scan

- Once the servicing image is verified clean, scan the active operating system files:

```
sfc /scannow
```

- Wait for the verification phase to hit 100%.

4.4 Interpret SFC Terminal Outputs

- **No Integrity Violations:** System structure is healthy.
- **Successfully Repaired:** System files were broken but fixed. (Issue resolved).
- **Unable to Fix:** Corrupt assets remain. (Requires Escalation).

4.5 Perform System Reboot

- Safely restart the workstation to finalize repairs:

```
shutdown /r /t 0
```

5. Expected Outcome

Corrupted Windows system binaries are automatically replaced with healthy, authenticated versions, stabilizing the environment.

6. Escalation & Documentation

Log the specific completion messages generated by the SFC tool inside the case ticket. If SFC is unable to process repairs, route the ticket to L2 Desktop Engineering.